COVER & CONTINUITY

Your continuity essentials

A checklist for unexpected absence: who steps in, what they can reach, and how clients are told.

AUDIENCE	FORMAT	VERSION	TIME
Psychologists · Psychiatrists	Checklist	1.0 · Nov 2026	30 minutes, then yearly

WHAT IT IS	A checklist for the arrangements that protect your clients if you are suddenly unable to practice.
USE IT WHEN	Now, then once a year, and whenever your practice systems or nominated colleagues change.
CUSTOMIZE FIRST	Your state's rules on records custody and your malpractice carrier's requirements. The full document is PA-03, Professional Will and Succession Plan.

1. Name the right people

- [ ] Nominate a professional executor: a licensed colleague who agrees to act if you cannot.
- [ ] Name a backup in case they are unavailable.
- [ ] Make sure a trusted person in your personal life knows who to call.

2. Make access possible

- [ ] List where records, schedules and contact lists are kept, and how the executor gets secure access.
- [ ] Keep credentials in a password manager with an emergency-access feature, never in a plain document.
- [ ] Check your EHR and phone provider's process for authorised access.

3. Make the plan practical

- [ ] Write the steps for telling clients, rescheduling and offering referrals.
- [ ] Include what your malpractice carrier and licensing board need to be told.
- [ ] Agree how records are kept for the period your state requires, and by whom.

4. Review your arrangements

- [ ] Review the plan once a year and after any change in systems or people.
- [ ] Record the date of the last review in PsyAlliance so colleagues see it is current.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

Records custody and retention periods are set by state law and your board's rules, and some states have specific professional-will requirements. Never store passwords or client lists in an unsecured document. This checklist is educational and is not legal or clinical advice; consider asking a healthcare attorney to review your plan.

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